

Answers to Questions received from prospective offerors
by 1:00 p.m. on Tuesday, February 11, 2025

1. Question: What is the current number of personnel assigned to maintenance activities, and what equipment is currently in use?

Answer: This is a performance-based contract. The number of personnel and the equipment used vary based on the contractor's operational approach, seasonal requirements, and workload intensity. Each contractor is responsible for determining the optimal number of personnel and equipment required to meet contract performance standards.

2. Question: Are there any safety or access restrictions that should be taken into account during maintenance operations?

Answer: Yes. All employees must undergo a security clearance process, which can be time-consuming. Additionally, all work must receive prior approval from the designated Safety Officer.

3. Question: Are there any specific requirements, preferences, or additional requests that should be incorporated into the proposal?

Answer: Prospective contractors should carefully review the Statement of Work (SOW), as it outlines all job descriptions and requirements in detail.

4. Question: Are there any special material specifications, certifications, or compliance conditions that must be met?

Answer: All materials must comply with Turkish quality standards and receive approval from both the Contracting Officer's Representative (COR) and the Safety Officer.

5. Question: How frequently should gutter cleaning be performed (e.g., daily, weekly, monthly)?

Answer: The contractor must perform gutter cleaning at least once every two months during the summer, once a month during the fall/autumn, and as needed during the winter at both the Chief of Mission Residence (CMR) and the Deputy Chief of Mission Residence (DCMR).

6. Question: Do you have any feedback regarding the previous maintenance process? In which areas would you like to see improvements?

Answer: Continuous, uninterrupted cleaning operations at the highest quality standard are essential. Contractors should ensure that cleaning processes are thorough and consistent.

7. Question: When can we expect to receive the documents related to the maintenance proposal?

Answer: Solicitation pack consisted of the Cover Page and SF1449-RFQ for Gardening Services was publicized on SAM.gov on 29 Jan 2025 under Notice ID: 19TU1525Q3003. Quotations are due by Monday, March 3rd, 2025, on or before 3:00 p.m. No quotations will be accepted after this time. Proposals must be in English and incomplete proposals will not be accepted.

8. Question: The Statement of Work (SOW) specifies that gutters should be cleaned at least twice a month in summer and once a week in winter. However, during the pre-proposal conference and site visit, it was mentioned that gutter cleaning would be required once a month. Could you confirm the correct frequency?

Answer: Please see the response to question 5.

9. Question: Will the Embassy provide salt and chemical solutions for snow and ice removal?

Answer: No. The contractor is responsible for providing de-icing solutions and salt. All materials must be approved by the COR and the Safety Officer.

10. Question: After snow and ice removal, should the accumulated snow and ice be transported outside the Embassy, CMR, and DCR premises?

Answer: No. Snow should be collected and stored at designated locations within the compounds.

11. Question: Can the entire gardening service be subcontracted, or alternatively, performed through a joint venture?

Answer: The Government does not restrict subcontracting or joint venture partnerships. The description of the organization of the joint venture must clearly define the expected role of each of the entities in the joint venture in delivering the requirements cited in the solicitation. Also, the offer should include the past experience of each of the JV partners. If the party actually performing the work is a subcontractor or joint venture partner, then such subcontractor or joint venture partner must comply with the requirements of paragraph (a) of the 652.242-73 AUTHORIZATION AND PERFORMANCE (AUG 1999) clause. Please refer to page 44 of the solicitation document under SECTION 2 - CONTRACT CLAUSES, ADDENDUM TO CONTRACT CLAUSES FAR AND DOSAR CLAUSES NOT PRESCRIBED IN PART 12 for further details.